Lesson 38: Unit 3 Review: Editing, Writing and a Presentation

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 3: Verb Tenses and Narration · The Human Lifespan

Adapted from High-Intermediate Academic Grammar for ESL Students by Rebecca Al Haider, Reedley College (CC BY 4.0): 11.1: Exercise 11-Editing; 11.2: Exercise 12-Writing; 11.3: Exercise 13-Presentation; Rubrics (Appendix A).

In this lesson

This lesson reviews the grammar of Unit 3: reported speech (Lesson 28), embedded questions (Lesson 33) and the simple future (Lesson 36). You will edit a student's summary paragraph about bias, write two paragraphs about a parenting style, and turn them into an 8- to 10-minute talk that you record and give to your tutor. Editing for specific grammar points and presenting what you have read are everyday skills in a psychology course.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Find and correct errors in reported speech, embedded questions and simple future verbs.
- Name the type of each error you correct.
- Write two paragraphs about a parenting style that use and label all three grammar forms.
- Plan, rehearse and record an 8- to 10-minute talk.
- Score your own writing and talk with the book's rubrics.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
reported speech	saying what another person said or wrote, in your own words	Claude Steele states that stereotype threat affects students' performance.
reporting verb	a verb that introduces reported speech: say, tell, ask, state, explain, report …	My sister says that she wants to win the lottery.
embedded question	a question inside a statement; it is a noun clause and uses statement word order	I don't know where my shoe is.
noun clause	a dependent clause that works like a noun (a subject or an object)	What she studies is difficult.
statement word order	the subject comes before the verb	where my shoe is (not: where is my shoe)
simple future	will + base verb, or be going to + base verb	The population will grow slowly.
bias	an unfair prejudice in favor of or against an idea, person, or group	Everyone has bias.

Word or phrase	Meaning	Example
in-group / out-group	the group you belong to / a group you do not belong to	in-group and out-group identity
per·CEIVE	see and understand someone or something in a certain way	how people perceive others
track changes	a word-processor tool that shows every change you make	Copy and paste the passage into a word processing document and track the changes.
parenting style	the general way parents raise and guide their children	Write two paragraphs about ONE of the parenting styles.
rubric	a table of goals and points used to score work	The writing rubric has five goals.
re·HEARSE	practise before the real event	The student has obviously prepared and rehearsed.

Rules and explanations

What to look for (from Lessons 28, 33 and 36)

Reported speech

- Reporting verb + (that) + clause: "Claude Steele states that stereotype threat affects students' performance."
- A reported statement starts with that (or no word). A reported yes/no question starts with if or whether: "He asked if I wanted a job."
- A present reporting verb (says, states) keeps the tense of the original words. A past reporting verb (said) usually moves the tense back: will → would, am going to → was going to.
- The book's common error: "according to" and a reporting verb in the same sentence.
  - Correct: According to Claude Steele, stereotype threat affects students' performance.
  - Wrong: According to Claude Steele states stereotype threat affects students' performance.
  - Correct: Claude Steele states that stereotype threat affects students' performance.

Embedded questions

- Use statement word order: question word + subject + verb, with no do, does or did. "What does she study?" → "I wonder what she studies." / "What she studies is difficult."
- An embedded question can be a subject, an object, the object of a preposition ("I would like you to focus on where my shoe is.") or an adjective complement ("It is unclear where my shoe is.").
- A direct question (with a question mark) keeps question word order: "Where is my shoe?"

Simple future

- will + base verb; will not (won't) + base verb; am/is/are going to + base verb. No -s, -ed or -ing after will.

- In academic writing, write will in full. Contractions such as I'll, she'll or a noun + 'll are for speech and informal writing.

Editing with track changes

The book asks you to copy the paragraph into a word processor and turn on track changes, so that every deletion and addition shows. In Microsoft Word, use Review → Track Changes; in Google Docs, use Suggesting mode. The two videos in Watch online show how. You can also edit the printed paragraph by hand: cross out each error and write the correction above it.

How your work is scored (the book's rubrics)

Each goal scores 4 (exemplary), 3 (satisfactory), 2 (approaching satisfactory) or 1/0 (unsatisfactory/incomplete). The best score is 20.

Writing assignment:

1. The paragraph includes each of the grammar forms. The grammar forms are underlined and labeled.
2. The grammar forms are accurately and appropriately used.
3. The paragraph is well developed and logically written.
4. The paragraph is word processed and double-spaced.
5. It is free from spelling, punctuation, and writing errors including comma splices and run-ons.

Presentation:

1. The presentation includes the unit's grammar, and it is used accurately and appropriately.
2. The content of the presentation aligns with (matches) the assignment.
3. The presentation tool uses appropriate color, images, and font to enhance the content.
4. The delivery of the presentation shows that the student has obviously prepared and rehearsed.
5. It is free from spelling, punctuation, and general writing errors.

> **Note for Arabic speakers** - Arabic writing often joins many clauses with "and" (wa) and commas. In English this makes run-on sentences and comma splices (writing rubric, goal 5). End each complete sentence with a period.

Practice

Exercise 11. Editing. Read the summary paragraph about bias, written by a human development and family studies student. Identify and correct the errors related to reported speech, embedded questions and simple future verbs. Track your changes in a word processor, or correct the printed copy. Then write the type of each error: reported speech, embedded question or simple future. Not every sentence has an error. The sentence numbers are added here to help you check.

(1) Bias is defined as an unfair prejudice in favor of or against an idea, person, or group. (2) How bias is formed? (3) According to Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald state that bias begins during infancy. (4) How you talk and what language do you speak can determine whether a baby favors you or

not. (5) Banaji and Greenwald state what our own identity impacts our interactions with others. (6) Although in-group and out-group identity is learned at a young age, children who are exposed to diverse groups of people will not developed the same bias as children who interact with only people of shared identity. (7) Everyone has bias. (8) Bias tests can provide a stronger picture of how do people perceive others. (9) Bias awareness'll help people take steps to reduce their biases.

Speak with your tutor

- "Check my corrections to Exercise 11. For each one, ask me to explain the type of error."
- "Give me ten sentences about child development with errors in reported speech, embedded questions or the simple future. I will correct them and name each error type."
- "Explain the four parenting styles (permissive, uninvolved, authoritarian, authoritative) in simple English. Then ask me which one is common in my culture and what will happen to children raised that way."
- "Here are my two paragraphs: [paste]. Score them with the writing rubric and check every labeled item (a, b, c)."
- "I am going to give you my talk now. Score it with the presentation rubric, then list my grammar errors by type."

Read aloud

Information questions and statements with an embedded question both have falling intonation (↘). An embedded question has no question mark.

- How is bias formed? (↘)
- Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald state that bias begins during infancy.
- How you talk and what language you speak can determine whether a baby favors you or not. (↘)
- Bias tests can provide a stronger picture of how people perceive others. (↘)
- Bias awareness will help people take steps to reduce their biases.
- According to Claude Steele, (pause) stereotype threat affects students' performance.

Writing task

Exercise 12: Writing

Write two paragraphs about ONE of the parenting styles. Describe the characteristics of the parenting style, any cultural associations, and the consequences of this style on children. a. Permissive b. Uninvolved c. Authoritarian d. Authoritative

Include each grammar form below at least one time. Underline each grammar item and label it with the correct letter each time you use it: a. reported speech b. embedded questions c. simple future

- The book gives no reading on parenting styles. Use your psychology textbook, or ask your tutor to explain the styles first. Then report what your source says (reported speech), for example: "My textbook explains that ..."

- Paragraph 1: the characteristics and any cultural associations. Paragraph 2: the consequences for children. About 7 to 10 sentences each, word processed and double-spaced.

Self-editing checklist (from the rubric):

- Each form (a, b, c) appears at least once, and every item is underlined and labeled.
- Reported speech: never "according to" + a reporting verb; after a past reporting verb, the tense moves back.
- Embedded questions: statement word order, no do, does or did.
- Simple future: will + base verb, written in full.
- Each paragraph has a topic sentence, and the ideas follow logically.
- No spelling or punctuation errors, comma splices or run-ons.

Paste your draft into the chat and ask your tutor for feedback. Then rewrite it.

Exercise 13: Presentation (a recorded talk for your tutor)

Give an 8- to 10-minute talk on the topic of your paragraphs: the characteristics of the parenting style, any cultural associations, and the consequences of this style on children. Try to use the unit's grammar.

1. **Plan.** Make 5 to 8 simple slides or note cards: title; characteristics; cultural associations; consequences; conclusion. Use a clear font, a few colors and one or two images. Check the spelling (rubric goals 3 and 5).
2. **Time.** Introduction 1 minute; characteristics 2 to 3; cultural associations 2; consequences 2 to 3; conclusion 1.
3. **Rehearse.** Practise aloud two or three times with a timer. Speak from your notes; do not read your paragraphs word for word (goal 4).
4. **Record.** Record yourself with your phone. Listen, note three things to improve, and record again.
5. **Give it to your tutor.** Give the talk in Live conversation, or paste the transcript of your recording into the chat. Ask for a score with the presentation rubric.

Watch online

- How to track changes in Microsoft Word: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rznrpH-zQy4
- How to track changes in Google Docs: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=X7yqViYSr74

Answer key

Exercise 11 (the book has no key for this exercise; each correction below follows the rules of Lessons 28, 33 and 36)

There are seven errors, in sentences 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8 and 9. Sentences 1 and 7 are correct.

Sentence	Error	Correction	Type of error
2	How bias is formed?	How is bias formed?	Embedded questions (word order): this is a direct question, not an embedded one (it ends with a question mark), so it needs question word order: be before the subject.
3	According to Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald state that bias begins during infancy.	Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald state that bias begins during infancy. (Also correct: According to Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald, bias begins during infancy.)	Reported speech: "according to" and a reporting verb cannot be in the same sentence.
4	what language do you speak	what language you speak	Embedded question (part of the subject): statement word order, no do.
5	state what our own identity impacts	state that our own identity impacts	Reported speech: a reported statement starts with that, not a question word.
6	will not developed	will not develop	Simple future: will not + base verb.
8	how do people perceive others	how people perceive others	Embedded question (object of the preposition "of"): statement word order, no do.
9	Bias awareness'll help	Bias awareness will help	Simple future: write will in full; do not contract it with a noun in academic writing.

In sentence 4, "whether a baby favors you or not" is already correct: whether + statement word order. In sentence 2, another correct choice is to put the question inside a statement, for example "It is important to understand how bias is formed."

Corrected paragraph: Bias is defined as an unfair prejudice in favor of or against an idea, person, or group. How is bias formed? Mahzarin Banaji and Anthony Greenwald state that bias begins during infancy. How you talk and what language you speak can determine whether a baby favors you or not. Banaji and Greenwald state that our own identity impacts our interactions with others. Although in-

group and out-group identity is learned at a young age, children who are exposed to diverse groups of people will not develop the same bias as children who interact with only people of shared identity. Everyone has bias. Bias tests can provide a stronger picture of how people perceive others. Bias awareness will help people take steps to reduce their biases.

My notes